



All About KOREA

Stories, Songs, Crafts
and Games for Kids

ANN MARTIN BOWLER

Illustrated by
SOOSONAM BARG



TUTTLE





Can white tigers protect you
from troubles to the west?

Can blue dragons protect you
from troubles to the east?

In Korea they can!

All About Korea takes you to meet Korea's people, places, and traditions. You'll learn the most fun and fascinating things about Korea, from the countryside to the busy cities like Seoul. Find out what happened when the king invented the Korean alphabet almost 600 years ago. Learn why the famous martial art called taekwondo began, why Korean kids write their name and birthday on a kite every year, and much more.

With dozens of stories, games, recipes and activities to try, **All About Korea** means a whole country of new things to see and do.

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"The scope of this book is remarkably comprehensive, covering almost anything a child would want to know." —School Library Journal

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... What a magnificent resource it is for families.

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All About **KOREA** Stories, Songs, Crafts and Games for Kids



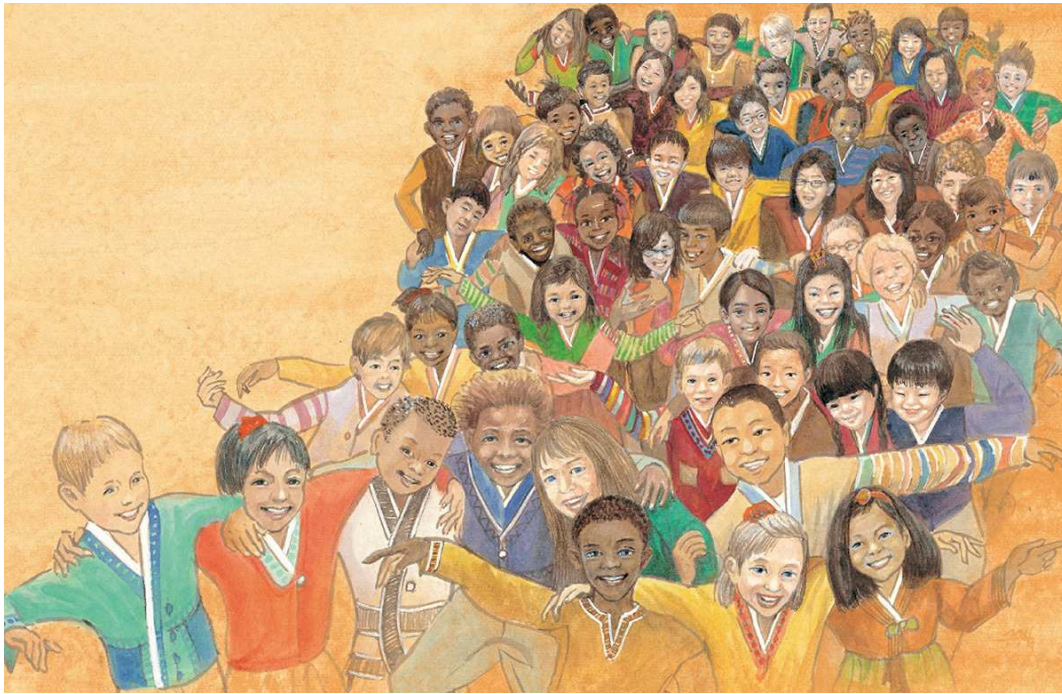
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SOOSONAM BARG  밝수수남

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ABOUT TUTTLE

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To Sarah and Jacob, who brought Korea home to us, with love and thanks.

— A. M. B.

I would like to dedicate my paintings to all the people who have made me who I am today.

— S. B.



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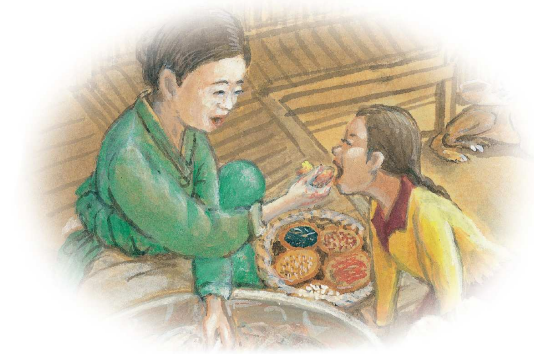
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Introducing Korea!

Ancient Culture, Modern Nation



What's the spiciest food you've ever eaten? How do you break a board with your bare hand? Why in the world would you send a message off on a kite at the end of the year? Can Blue Dragons protect you?

Korean kids know the answers, and in this book, you'll learn too. You'll learn the foods Korean kids eat, the stories they enjoy and the art and crafts they make. You will learn games Korean kids play, the songs they sing and how Korean families celebrate holidays and birthdays. Some of these activities are fairly new but most are well-loved ways that have been around in Korea for generations.

Welcome to the rich and wonderful traditions of Korea!



Fast Facts

Country Name: Republic of Korea **Capital City:** Seoul

Official Language: Korean **Population:** 48,508,972

Total land area: 38,022 square miles (98,477 sq. km) **Tallest mountain:** Halla-san, 6,398 ft (1,950m) **Government type:** Democracy **Money:** South Korean Won

Main exports: Clothing, electronic products, fish, footwear, cars **Main Religions:** Buddhism, Christianity, Confucianism

A Bit of History

A Tough People Settle a Rugged Land



The first Koreans moved from northern Asia and settled in Korea around 5,000 years ago. These early Koreans lived in villages and survived by farming and hunting. Later, in the year 668, Korea became a nation.

With Japan to its southeast and China to its northwest, Korea often needed courage and strength to fend off its more powerful neighbors. Korea was known as the “Hermit Kingdom,” because Korea just wanted to be left alone!



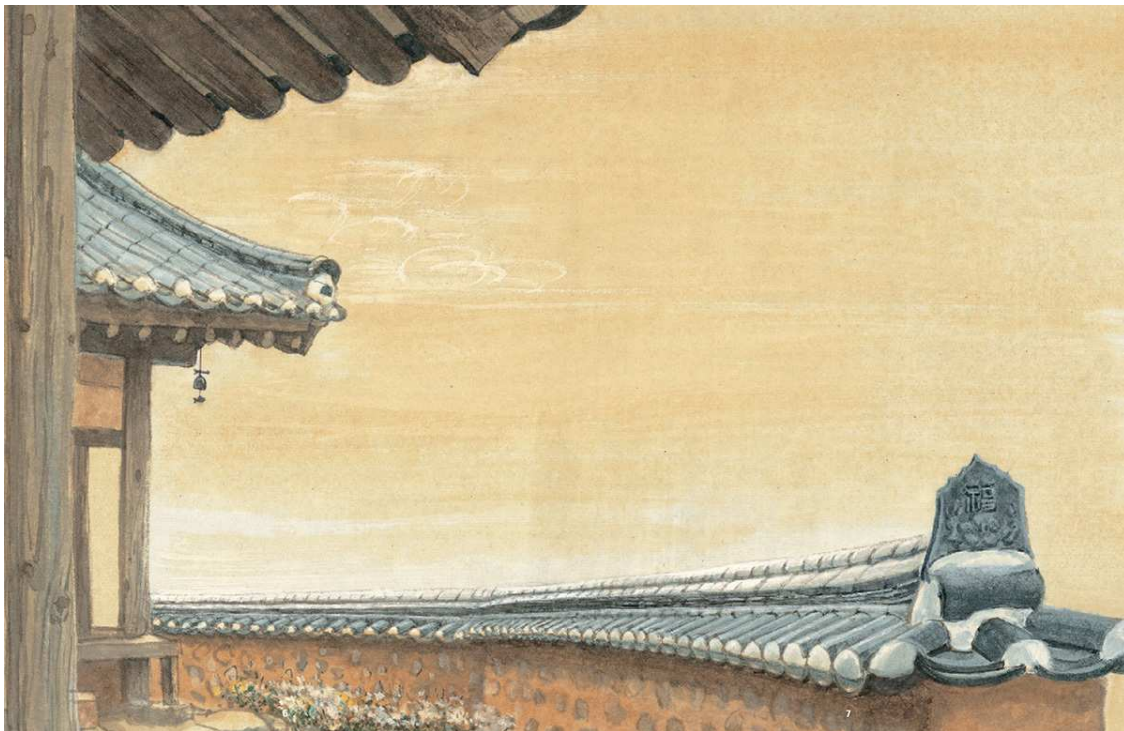
Korea is a rugged, mountainous country on a 600-mile-long (966km-long) peninsula. Korea has four distinct seasons. Summer is hot, humid and rainy while spring and fall are usually pleasant and comfortable. Winter is often cold and snowy, especially in the northern part of the country.

Being a nation for so long helped make Koreans a unified people. Koreans speak the same language, look fairly similar and share many of the same ways and traditions.

Over time, Koreans created ways of life and art that expressed their own special style. Beautiful temples and shrines were built.

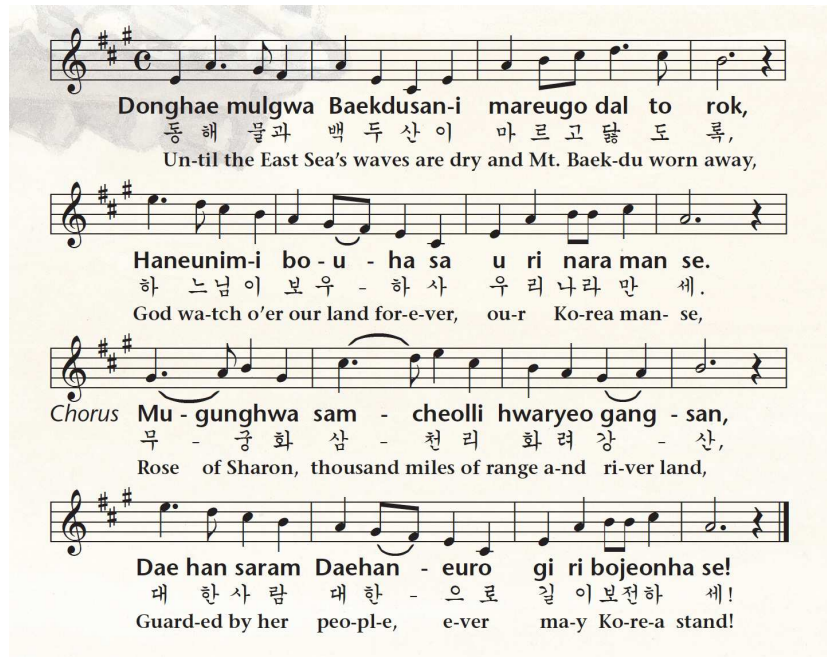
In 1945, Korea was sadly broken into two countries, South Korea and North Korea. A wide military border was set up, separating the two. It became almost impossible to visit friends and relatives in the other Korea. That has been very difficult for Koreans, who dearly value family and friendship.

Though the governments of the two countries are still at odds, many continue to hope that Korea will be one nation again. Since 1945, the governments and ways of life of North and South Korean people have gone in different directions. ***All About Korea*** is about life in today's South Korea.



The Korean National Anthem

Ae-guk-ga 애국가



Donghae mulgwa Baekdusan-i mareugo dal to rok,
동해 물과 백두산이 마르고 닳도록,
Un-til the East Sea's waves are dry and Mt. Baek-du worn away,

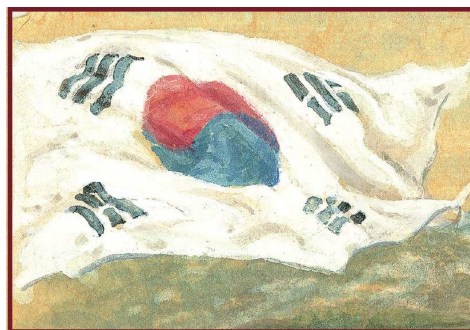
Haneunim-i bo - u - ha sa u ri nara man se.
하느님이 보우 - 하사 우리나라 만세.
God wa-tch o'er our land for-e-ver, ou-r Ko-re-a man- se,

Chorus Mu - gunghwa sam - cheolli hwaryeo gang - san,
무 - 궁화 삼 - 천리 화려강 - 산,
Rose of Sharon, thousand miles of range a-nd ri-ver land,

Dae han saram Daehan - euro gi ri bojeonha se!
대한사람 대한 - 으로 길이보전하세!
Guard-ed by her peo-pl-e, e-ver ma-y Ko-re-a stand!

The South Korean Flag

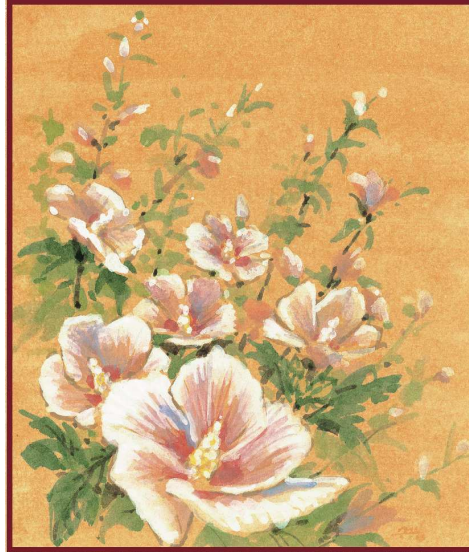
Taegeuk-gi 태극기



What does the South Korean flag mean? The blue and red circle in the middle is called **taegeuk**, "yin and yang." It means that everything has an opposite—like day and night, male and female, north and south—and it stands for the balance in life. The black symbols near each corner stand for the things that make up our universe: heaven, earth, water and fire.

Korea's National Flower

Mu-gung-hwa 무궁화



Koreans love the flower Rose of Sharon! Why? The sturdy **mugunghwa** can have thousands of blossoms, and it blooms all summer long. So it is a perfect symbol for the hardy Korean people who have worked together to overcome many challenges.

Korea Today

Hard Work Has Paid Off



In 1945, South Korea was a young but struggling nation. Years of military rule and war had left South Korea one of Asia's poorest countries. But the Korean people did not give up. They worked hard to make their country and government stronger. Koreans decided that education was the way to a better future. They built universities and insisted that all children go to school.

The hard work of the South Korean people paid off. Korea is now a world leader in the production of cars, ships, machines and electronics. Today Korea is very advanced technologically. Almost all Koreans use the Internet and have cell phones. The entertainment industry is also booming. Korean music, TV shows and films are popular across Asia.

With nearly 50 million citizens, Korea is a crowded country. Because it has so many mountains, its flat land is especially precious, and is used either for farming or for cities.

In the modern city of Seoul, the capital city, very old palaces and shrines sit next to tall apartment houses and skyscrapers.

Religion and Wisdom

Ancient Korean Wisdom



Even though Korea is now a very modern nation, three ancient belief systems still are important.

Long ago, Koreans believed that things like trees, rivers and animals were filled with spirits, and that some could communicate with spirits. This belief was called **Shamanism**. It is Korea's oldest belief. Though this old religion has faded, elements of it still exist in Korea today.

The Korean people are guided by the ancient ideas of **Confucius**, a wise Chinese man who lived around 2,500 years ago. Education and friendship are important in **Confucianism**, as is showing respect to your ancestors and elders.

Buddhism came to Korea in 372. Buddha taught that through meditation and living a simple life, a person can achieve a perfect state of mind called "enlightenment." Today, more than 7,000 beautiful Buddhist temples dot the Korean landscape and about 23% of South Koreans consider themselves to

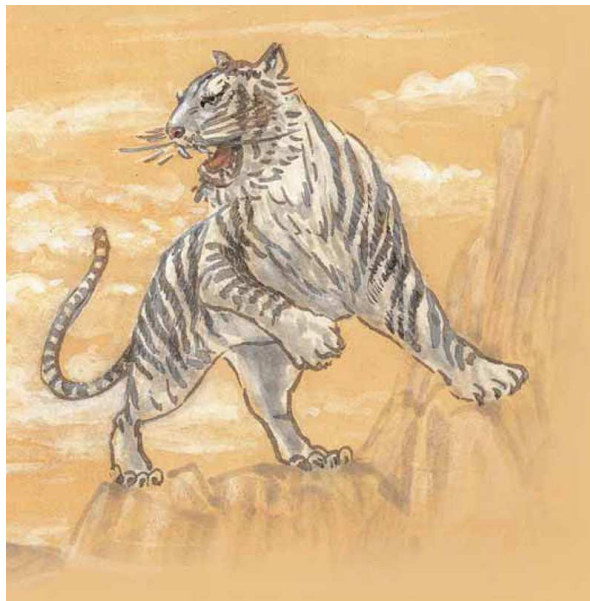
be Buddhist.

Catholicism arrived in Korea in 1794 and Protestant faiths entered Korea during the 1880s. Before long, thousands of Koreans had converted to **Christian** faiths. Today, about 29% of South Koreans call themselves Christians.

KOREAN PROVERBS

Sok-dam 속담

Though Korea is a modern nation, Korean parents continue to tell their children the same time-tested bits of wisdom their own parents told them. Why do parents repeat old proverbs? In the hope that their children will become dependable, compassionate, hardworking adults!



Blue Dragons & White Tigers

Long ago, Koreans believed Blue Dragons brought rain and controlled the seas, and White Tigers could change shapes and become other animals. Both were considered very powerful.

An old Korean saying, “Blue Dragons on our left side, White Tigers on our right side,” is about the Korean belief that White Tigers protected Koreans from evils coming from the west and Blue Dragons protected them from the east. Koreans took these beliefs from an ancient Chinese philosophy called *feng shui*.

Today, most of Korea’s 7,000 temples have Blue Dragons on the east side and White Tigers on the west side.



A Korean Folktale

Taming a Tiger

Koreans feared and respected the tigers that once roamed their mountains. Here is one of many wonderful Korean tales about tigers.

“Jung, thank goodness you’re home!” cried Ogi, rushing to her husband. “Come sit down. Tell me, is the war over?”

But Jung only replied, “Give me peace, woman!”

Ogi told Jung funny stories, trying to cheer him up. But he said sternly, “Enough, woman! Let me rest!”

Then Ogi decided, “My husband is too thin! Some homemade food will do him good.”

But no matter what Ogi cooked, Jung pushed it away saying, “This bulgogi is overcooked!” or “This is too salty!” or “This isn’t spicy enough!”

A few days later, Jung finally set off to farm their land. At first Ogi was overjoyed, but her happiness didn’t last long. “My husband is worthless! Look at him. He just sits and stares at the sea! His body is home, but the loving man I knew is gone. What should I do?”

One day Ogi heard about a wise old hermit who made healing potions. She set out for his home right away. The old man answered his door gruffly. “What do you want?”

Ogi answered politely, “Wise One, I need a magic potion.”

Sighing, the old man said, “What is your story?”

“My husband is not himself,” began Ogi, her voice quivering. When Ogi finished her sad tale, the Wise One replied, “Yes, this happens sometimes when men return from war.”

Encouraged, Ogi asked hopefully, “Wise One, can you make a potion so my husband will be himself again?”

“So simple, is it?” the old hermit laughed. But after a long while, he said, “This potion is most difficult but it can be made. The key ingredient is the whisker of a living tiger. Bring me a whisker and I will make a magic potion.”

Ogi was astonished. “The whisker from a living tiger? Impossible!”

“If helping your husband is important enough, you will find a way,” the hermit replied, as he shut his door.

“A tiger’s whisker? I would be killed!” Ogi worried. But Jung did not improve, so finally, one sleepless night, Ogi took some rice and meat, tiptoed from her dark house and hiked to caves where tigers were known to live.



Standing far from the caves, Ogi sang in a shaking voice, “Tiger, sweet tiger, dinnertime!” But by daybreak, no tiger had appeared so Ogi left the food and headed home.

Each night, Ogi faithfully brought food and forced herself closer to the tigers' caves. She sang sweetly for hours on end, "Tiger, sweet tiger, dinnertime."

One night, a tiger seemed to be waiting for Ogi on the trail. Ogi was so startled she dropped the food. She shivered as the powerful animal gobbled it up.

From then on, the tiger met Ogi on the trail. In the dark, Ogi smelled the tiger's hot breath and heard him chew. She was delighted to see his tail swish when she sang, "Tiger, sweet tiger! Dinnertime!"

One night Ogi forced herself to reach out and scratch the thick fur behind the tiger's ear. To her amazement, the tiger purred! From then on, Ogi not only scratched the tiger's neck but petted his long powerful sides as well.



Seven nights later, while the tiger was enjoying her scratching, Ogi drew a deep breath and said, "Tiger, my friend, I need one of your whiskers. Please don't be angry." The tiger didn't seem to notice as Ogi cut off a whisker.

Clutching the whisker, Ogi ran straight to the hermit's house. "Wise One!" Ogi called excitedly, "I have a tiger's whisker! Please make a potion so my husband will be happy again."

The hermit studied the whisker sleepily. Satisfied it was from a living tiger, he dropped it into his fire.

“No!” cried Ogi. “Don’t burn the whisker!”

The old hermit answered calmly, “Tell me, how did you get the whisker?”

“I brought the tiger food each night,” Ogi said. “At first, I stood far from the caves. Each night I went closer, singing ‘Tiger, sweet tiger, dinnertime,’ over and over. I was tired, but I didn’t give up. I went night after night and finally, finally, the tiger came to me. Soon he ate out of my hand and purred when I scratched him. It was then that I took a whisker.”

“I am impressed! Through your kindness and patience, you tamed a tiger!” the hermit said warmly.

“I guess I did. But you burned the whisker!” Ogi said sadly. “All my work was for nothing.”

“You are wrong. Your work was most important. The whisker is no longer needed,” the hermit said firmly. “Ogi, come sit beside me. I need to ask some questions.”



Settling in front of the fire, the hermit asked, “Who is more fierce, your husband or the tiger you tamed?”

“The tiger, of course,” Ogi replied.

“If you can win the love and confidence of a wild animal by your

kindness, could you not do the same with your husband?” the hermit asked.

Ogi was speechless. But then, with a smile on her face, Ogi thanked the hermit and raced toward home, thinking all the while of what she had learned from the wise old hermit.

A KOREAN PROVERB

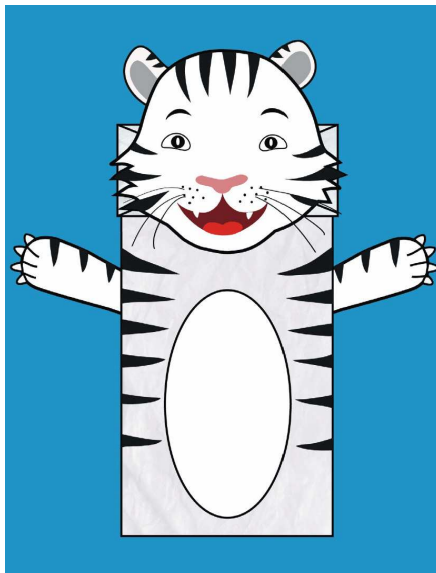
Horangi gure gaya horangi-reul jam-neunda.

호랑이 굴에 가야 호랑이를 잡는다.

“If you want to catch a tiger, you have to go to the tiger’s cave.”

This is a well-known Korean proverb. It means: Work hard! You must overcome difficulties to achieve your goals!

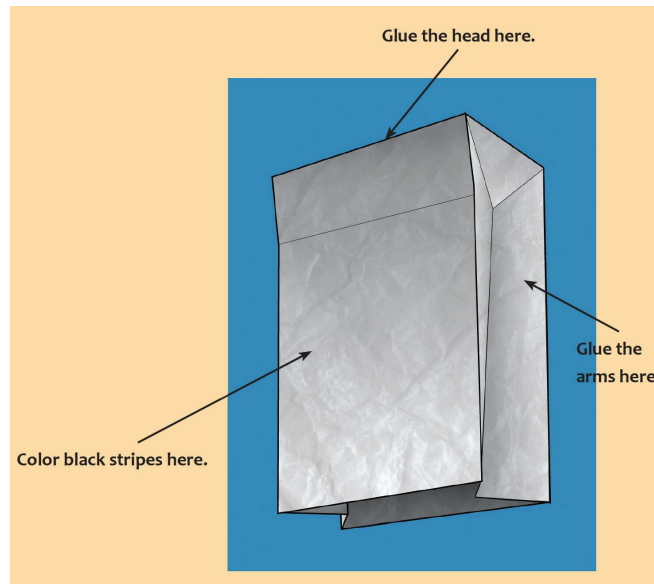
Make a Korean White Tiger Puppet



You will need:

- White paper lunch bag
- Glue, scissors

- Black crayon or marker
- Wiggly eyes (optional)



To make it:

1. Draw your own tiger head and arms on paper, color them, then cut them out. (Or print out the template at www.tuttlepublishing.com; use a photocopier to enlarge it 200%.) If you are using wiggly eyes, glue them on the face.
2. Color black stripes on the paper bag to make the tiger's body.
3. Glue the head onto the folded "bottom" part of the paper bag.
4. Glue the arms into the side folds of the bag.
5. Slip your hand into the puppet. Wave your fingers to move its head.

Language Lessons **Can You Say It in Korean?**



Korea's alphabet is called **hangeul**. It is considered one of the most well designed alphabets in the world. Each character's shape is based on the shape of a person's mouth, throat and tongue when they say the sound!

The hangeul alphabet was invented around 1443 during the reign of the great King Sejong. Before that time, Koreans wrote with complicated Chinese characters. That meant only the rich people, who had lots of time to study, were able to read and write. King Sejong wanted a reading and writing system that everyone could learn, even busy working people, so he created hangeul.

King Sejong would be pleased...almost everyone can read and write in South Korea today.

Now try saying something in Korean!

English	Pronunciation	Hangeul
yes	ne	네
no	aniyo	아니요
hello, how are you?	an-yeong haseyo	안녕하세요
thank you	gamsa hamnida	감사합니다
mother	eo-meoni	

		어머니
father	a-beoji	아버지
one	hana	하나
two	dul	둘
three	set	셋
four	net	넷
five	daseot	다섯

Calligraphy

Seo-ye 서예

The word *calligraphy* means “beautiful writing.” But Korean calligraphy is far more than just good handwriting. For many hundreds of years, people have admired a carefully crafted calligraphy scroll...just the way they might admire a fine painting.

All Korean children learn calligraphy in school. They practice by carefully copying well-known proverbs like this one:

Ga-hwa-man-sa-seong

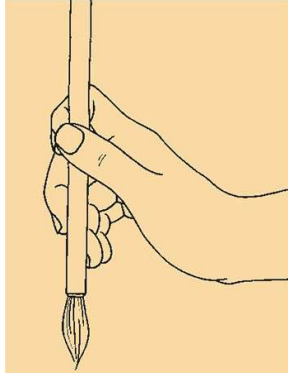
가화만사성

“To succeed in society, we need a happy family first.”

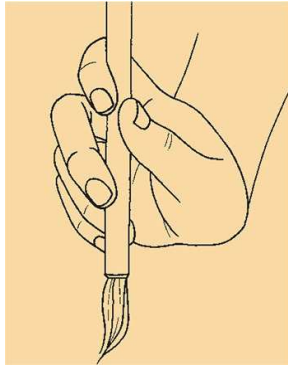
Korean Calligraphy Proverb

Try using calligraphy to copy your favorite Korean proverb. Look through this book to choose one.

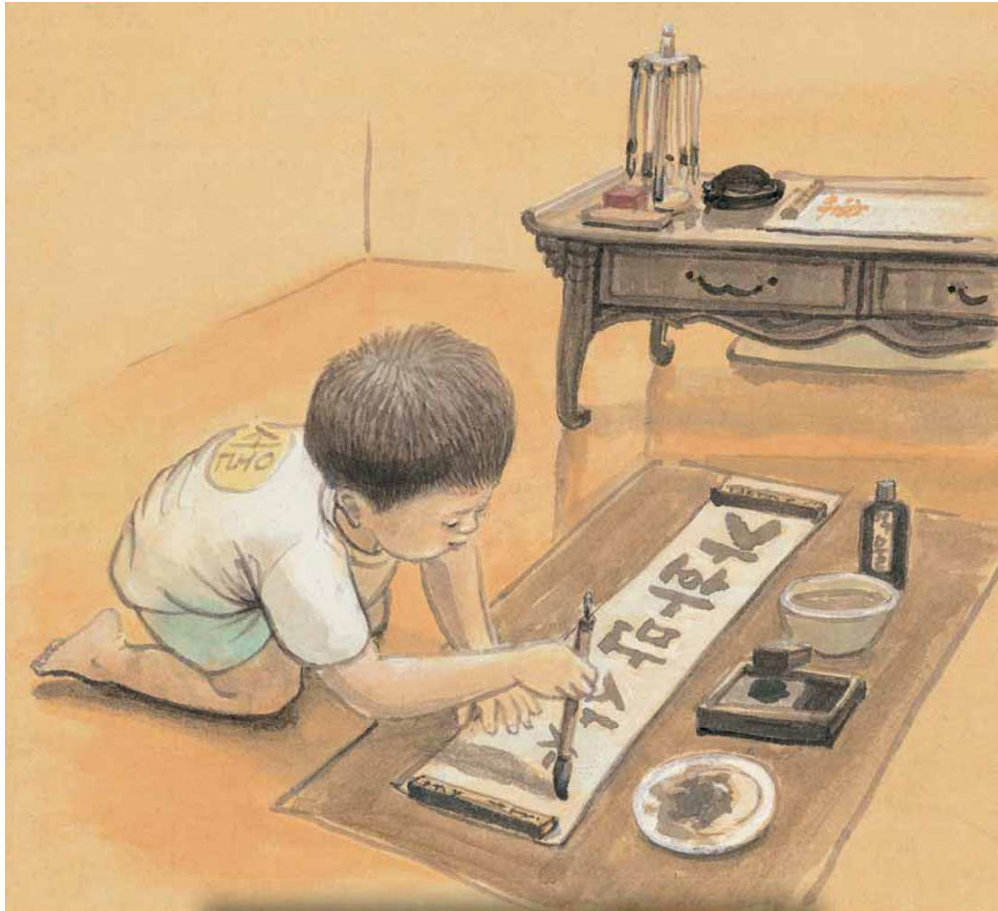
You will need:



- Black ink or black tempera paint (the paint is easier to clean up than ink) Pointed brush
- with 1" (2.5cm) bristles (a firmer brush is better for beginners) Practice paper A 4" × 17" (10cm × 44cm) sheet of good quality paper To make it:



- 1.** Practice your strokes on paper scraps before beginning.
- 2.** Hold your paintbrush gently in an upright position, supporting the brush; follow the diagrams at right.
- 3.** Dip the brush tip into ink. Change the pressure on your brush to get different thicknesses for your lines.
- 4.** Hang your best work up, since it is a special piece of art!



In old times, Korean men would have a special low desk, where they kept the “Scholar’s Four Friends.” The “Scholar’s Four Friends” is a name for the tools you use for calligraphy: a brush, paper, an ink stick and an ink stone. You rub the ink stick against the ink stone with water, to make your own ink.

A KOREAN PROVERB

Aneun gil-do mureo gara.

아는 길도 물어 가라.

“Even if you know the way, ask one more time.”

Meaning: It would be wise to make sure before you take action.



Fan dancers performed for the royal court, dressed in silky **hanboks**. The dance was serene and graceful to honor their king.

Music and Dance

Toes Tap and Fans Fly!

Koreans have always enjoyed music, especially singing and drumming. Long ago, Korean royalty and the wealthy people listened to the slow and serious melodies of the style called “court music.” And common people liked the lively rhythms of the style called “folk music.”

Today, Koreans like many styles of music and dance. They are very fond of karaoke. But traditional Korean music is as treasured today as it has been for centuries.

In days past, court musicians played horns, flutes, harps and stringed instruments to entertain the royalty during banquets and religious ceremonies. Korea’s best-known traditional instrument is the 12-stringed **gayageum**.

Country people traditionally played folk music during the spring season hoping for good crops, or during the fall in thanks for a good harvest. Farmer bands used drums, gongs and flutes to play melodies that were simple, but the strong rhythms and energy made their music unforgettable.

Want to experience Korean music or dance? It’s never been easier! Type “Korean drumming,” “Korean fan dance” or “gayageum” into a computer search engine, to find some of the fine recordings posted on the internet. While listening to a recording of Korean drumming, tap out the rhythm using your Korean drum. Notice how the rhythm changes.

Make a Buk Drum



You will need:

- An empty round oatmeal carton with lid Colored construction paper
-



Tape, safety scissors, glue stick and a pencil

To make it:

1. Trace the end of the oatmeal carton onto the construction paper twice. Cut out both circles and glue them to the ends of the carton.
2. Wrap the carton in colored construction paper. Cut the paper to fit, then tape it in place.
3. To make your drum look more authentic, decorate the paper before putting it on the drum. You can study the illustrations in this book for some decorating ideas.



The dance called **samulnori** is based on the farmer's dance, one of Korea's oldest folk dances. Lively dancers wear hats decorated with long, colorful ribbons attached on top. Gongs and round drums called **buk** keep the beat as dancers play double-headed hourglass-shaped **janggu** drums. They twirl, spin and flick their heads, making the ribbons float through the air.

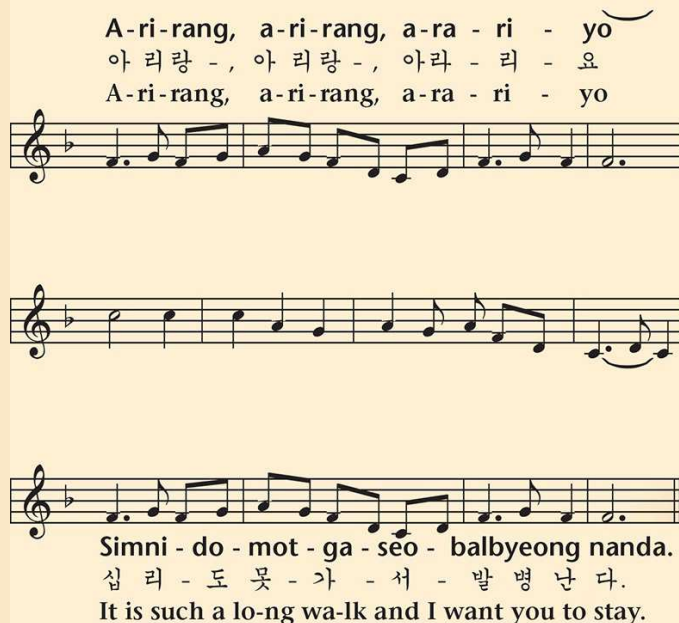
Singing Time

Koreans Love to Sing!

Koreans love to sing! In days past, Koreans sang while working in the fields to help pass the time. “Arirang” is Korea’s favorite and most powerful folk song.

What does “arirang” mean? There’s no exact English translation, but it has a message of “accepting pain as a part of life.” Koreans have sung the verses of “Arirang” to overcome all kinds of hardships. With a history of wars and separations, it is not surprising that Koreans feel a sense of closeness when they sing “Arirang” together.

Arirang 아리랑



A-ri-rang, a-ri-rang, a-ra - ri - yo
아 리 랑 -, 아 리 랑 -, 아 라 - 리 - 요
A-ri-rang, a-ri-rang, a-ra - ri - yo

Simni - do - mot - ga - seo - balbyeong nanda.
십 리 - 도 못 - 가 - 서 - 발 땡 난 다.
It is such a lo-ng wa-lk and I want you to stay.



Friendship Facts

- Koreans greatly value their friendships. They give gifts as a sign of friendship.
- Losing one's temper is considered very bad manners.
- Koreans often greet anyone older than themselves with a small bow.



Head, Shoulders, Knees and Feet

Meori, Eokkae, Mureup, Bal 머리 어깨 무릎 발

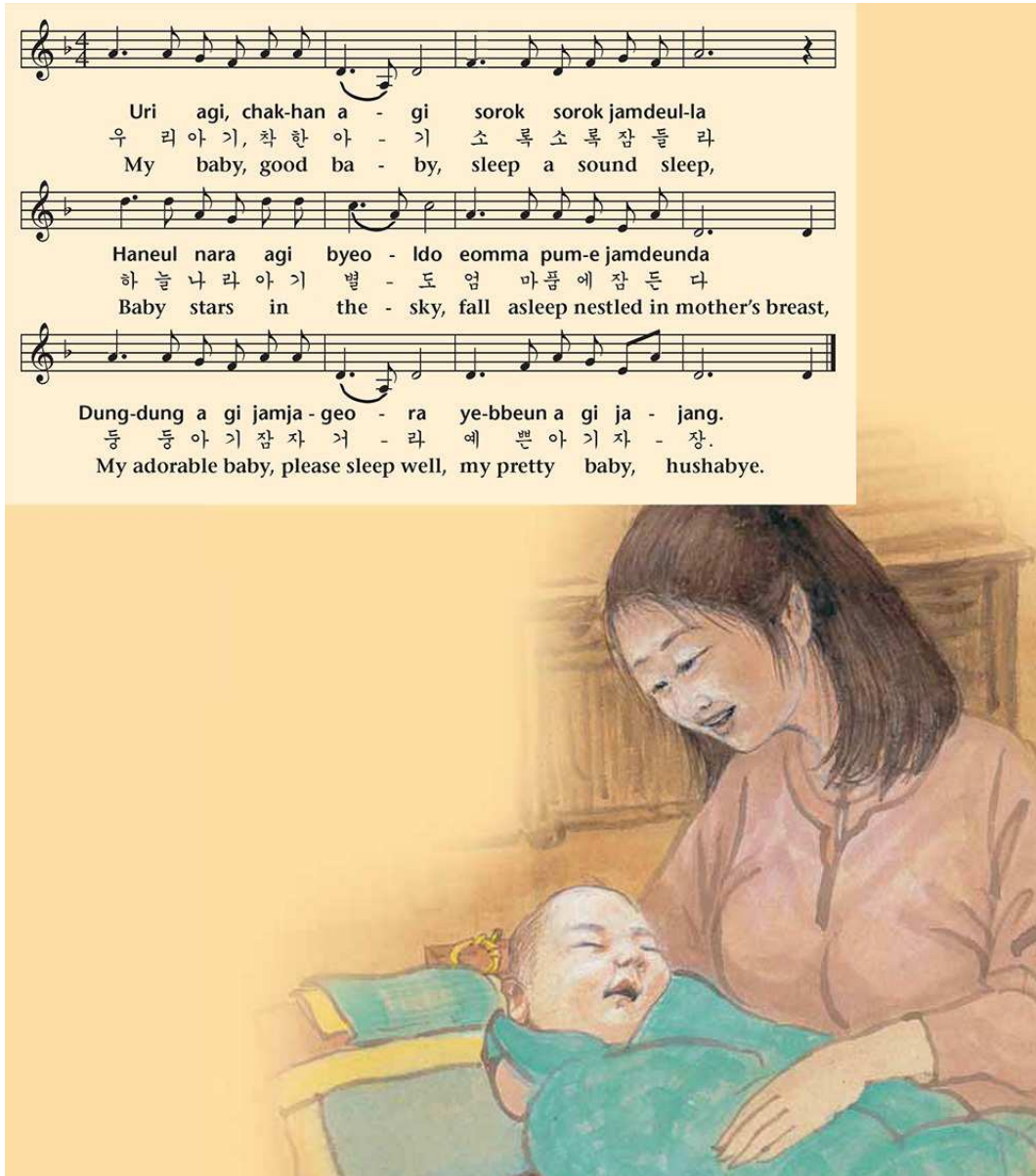
This popular action song can easily be sung in Korean. But take note! The tune is the same but the Korean words are a bit different from the song you might be used to.

Meo-ri, eo-kkae, mureup, bal, mureup, bal 머 리 어 깨 무릎 발 무릎 발 Head, shoulders, knees, feet, knees, feet	Meo-ri, eo-kkae, mureup, bal, mureup, bal 머 리 어 깨 무릎 발 무릎 발 Head, shoulders, knees, feet, knees, feet
Meori, eokkae, bal -, mureup, bal 머 리 어 깨 발 - 무릎 발 Head, shoulders, feet, knees, feet	Meo - ri, eokkae, mureup, nun, ko -, gwi! 머 리 어 깨 무릎 눈 코 - 귀! Head, shoulders, knees, eyes, nose, ears!

A Korean Lullaby

Ja-jang-ga 자장가

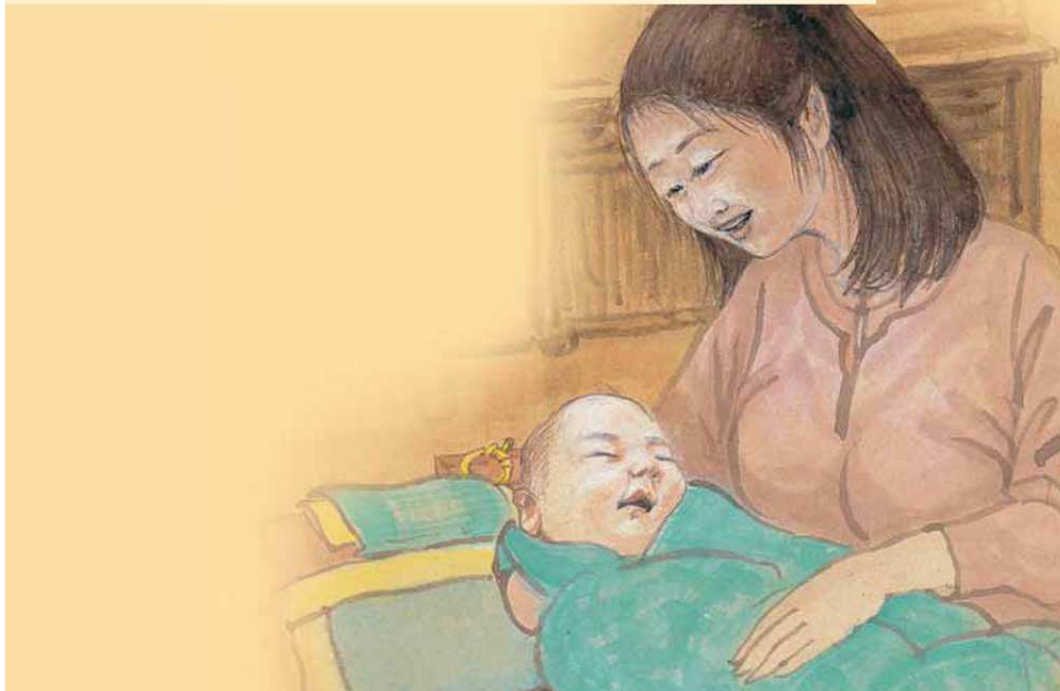
Parents around the world sing to their little ones to help them get to sleep. This is Korea's most well-known lullaby. It was written by Kim Dae-hyun 김대현.



Uri agi, chak-han a - gi sorok sorok jamdeul-la
우 리 아 기, 착 한 아 - 기 소 록 소 록 잠 들 라
My baby, good ba - by, sleep a sound sleep,

Haneul nara agi byeo - ldo eomma pum-e jamdeunda
하 늘 나 라 아 기 별 - 도 엄 마 품 에 잠 든 다
Baby stars in the - sky, fall asleep nestled in mother's breast,

Dung-dung a gi jamja - geo - ra ye-bbeun a gi ja - jang.
둥 둥 아 기 잠 자 거 - 라 예 뽀 아 기 자 - 장.
My adorable baby, please sleep well, my pretty baby, hushabye.



A soft, warm illustration of a mother with long dark hair, wearing a pinkish-brown top, gently holding her baby. The baby is lying down, wearing a green onesie, and appears to be sleeping peacefully. The background is a warm, golden-yellow color, suggesting a cozy, dimly lit room.

Korean Arts and Crafts

Bold and Beautiful



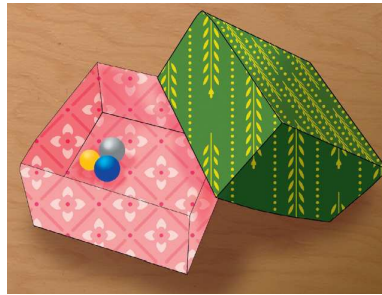
From paintings to sculptures to careful building designs, Korean art often has the theme of “being in harmony with nature.”

Although Japanese, Chinese and Korean artwork share some things in common, Korean art is especially known for...

- Amazing **pottery**, especially the elegantly simple, jade-green pottery called **celadon**.
- Special ways of using **paper**.
- Some of the world’s finest **sculptures of Buddha**.

- **Calligraphy**. It's more than writing in Korea: it is a form of art.
- **Masks**. Some Korean masks look silly. Others are grotesque or beautiful. Over time, the remarkable masks from Korea have been used in wars, in ceremonies, to drive away evil spirits...and today, even as key chains!
- Clothes and wall hangings decorated with colorful, finely detailed **embroidery**.

Make a Korean Paper Box



Koreans have been using paper since at least the fourth century. Long ago, Koreans used paper for windows and doors, for building cabinets and desks, and to make many household items like combs, bowls and jars. Some of these items were varnished to make them shiny, strong and waterproof.

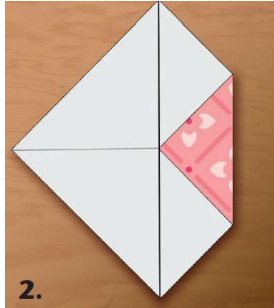
This little folded box can hold keepsakes or be filled with a small but special gift.

You will need:

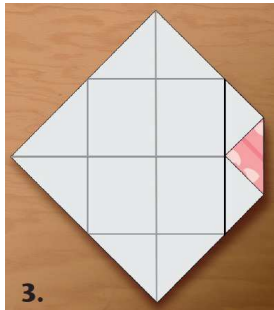
- 2 square sheets of paper, at least 6" × 6" (15cm × 15cm) in size. Sturdy wrapping paper works best.

To make it:

1. Begin with the paper colored side down. Fold the first sheet in half to make a triangle. Open sheet. Repeat fold on the other diagonal.
2. Fold one corner in to the center. Open sheet. Repeat with all corners.



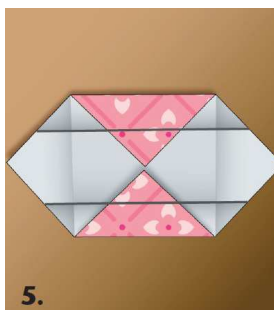
3. Fold the corner to meet its closest fold. Open sheet. Repeat with all corners.



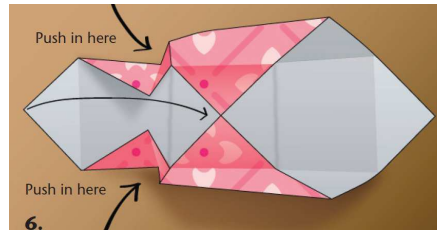
4. Fold the corner to meet the fold line across the center fold. Open sheet. Repeat with all corners. Now all the fold lines are in place!



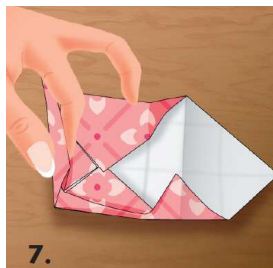
5. To begin to shape the box, first fold the top and bottom corners in to meet at the center. Now fold the top and bottom edges in to meet at the center. Then unfold the edges back halfway, so they form 2 sides standing up at right angles from the bottom. The first 2 sides of your box are complete!



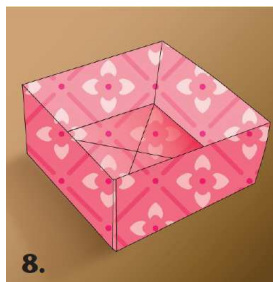
6. Now you will fold the 3rd side. Push a finger in at each of the two spots marked on the diagram, and fold the point in to reach the center of the box's bottom.



7. You will need to pinch and adjust as you do this folding, to make the box's new side and corners sharp and symmetrical.



8. Repeat Steps 6 and 7 on the final corner. This creates the 4th side of your box.



9. Using the other square of paper, repeat all steps to create the box bottom. Ease the triangle folds slightly in Step 6 to make the boxes fit well together.

The Many Masks of Korea

Long ago, Korean mask dances were a part of religious ceremonies. Later, mask dances were performed outdoors by farmers and common people, giving them a break from their hard work. They acted out mask dances to poke fun at powerful people like government officials or scholars. During Korean mask dance dramas, the audience often joins in, clapping and laughing and even dancing with the performers.

Korean masks are usually made from wood, gourds, or paper masks.

Korean masks are usually made from wood, gourds or paper mache. Their colors and details make it easy to recognize the different characters of a mask dance. A few of the most familiar are:



- **Nobleman Mask:** This has a long black beard, and a trick. When the actor holds his head up, the mask looks cheerful. When he looks down, the mask looks mean.
- **Scholar Mask:** In mask dramas, the Scholar thought he was better than other people. Though he is supposed to be studying, he wastes much time.
- **Old Granny:** She has a small, wrinkled face that shows she has had a hard life. In mask dramas, Granny often gossips about what others are doing.

Make a Paper-mache Mask

You will need:

- Aluminum foil
- Tape
- Tempera paint
- Elastic strap
- Newspaper
- Glue
- Paintbrush

To make it:

1. To make a cast of your face, cut a long piece of aluminum foil. Fold it over 3 or 4 times so that it is slightly larger than your face.
2. Have a friend press the foil gently into all parts of your face.

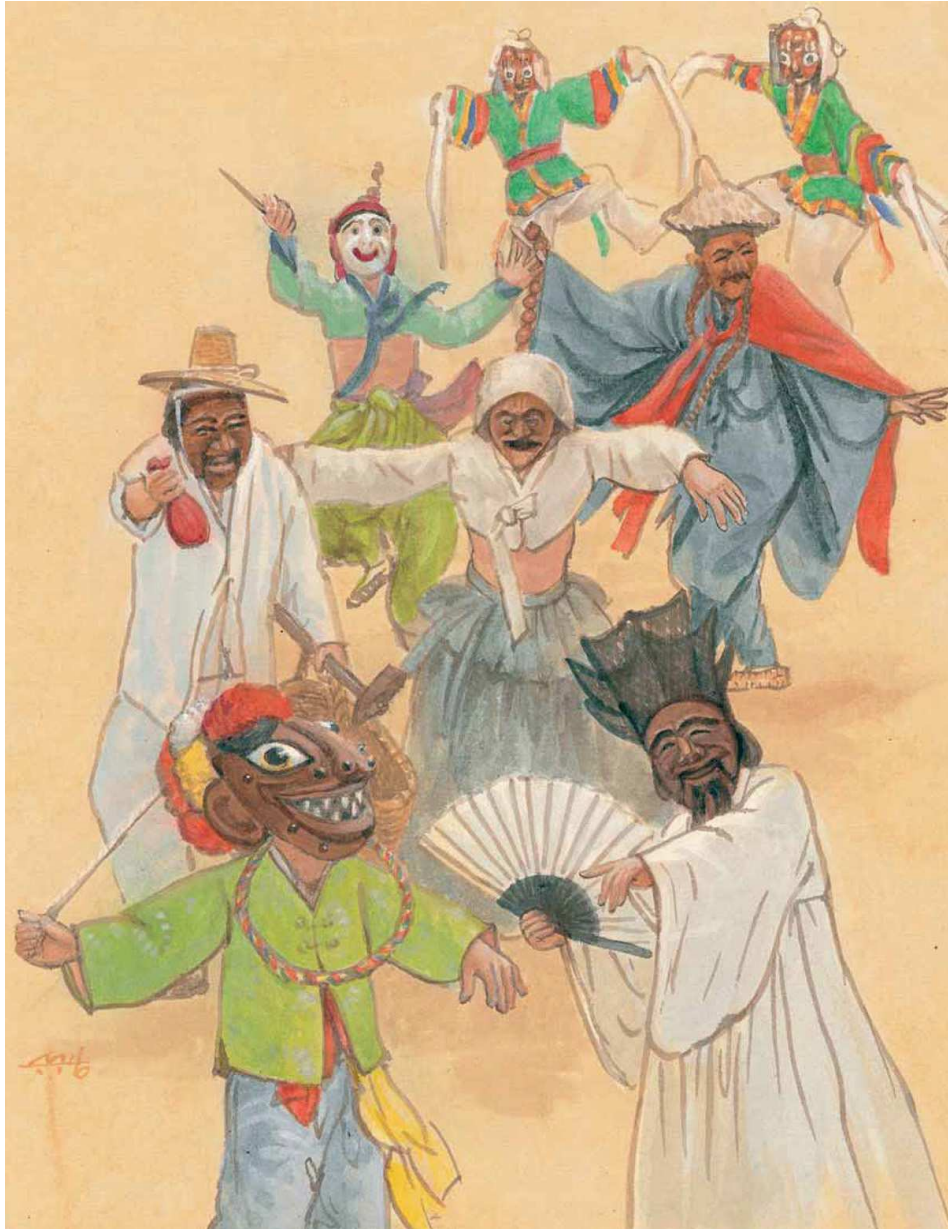
3. Remove carefully. Roll the foil edges to make a small rim.



4. Carefully fill your face mold with crumpled newspaper. Tape the rolled edge to hold it in place.
5. Make a paste from equal parts water and glue.
6. Cut or tear strips of newspaper and dip them into the glue mixture. Gently place wet strips over the face mold until its entire surface is covered. Let it dry overnight.



7. Repeat Step 6 two more times, for a thicker mask. Use twisted newspaper to add details like horns, ears, or a nose. When completely dry, remove the newspaper stuffing. Ask a grown up to help you cut eyeholes.
8. Add a final layer of paper strips, as in Step 6, if you want to make the mask surface smoother.
9. When it is dry, paint your mask. Then add an elastic strap, "hair," "beard," or other decorations.



Traditional Clothing

Hanboks for the Holidays



Korea's traditional clothing is called the **hanbok**. Before the arrival of Western-style clothing 100 years ago, hanboks were what people wore every day in Korea. Wealthy Koreans always wore colorful hanboks but everyone else usually wore white hanboks.

Today almost all Koreans wear Western-style clothing, but people still wear vibrant colored hanboks during holidays and for special occasions.

Jeogori 저고리

A loose-fitting top that covers the arms and upper body. You can see its white and green collar peeking out at the man's and the boy's neck.

Durumagi 두루마기

A topcoat worn to keep warm. The man is wearing a brown one.

Magoja 마고자

A short jacket worn over the **jeogori**. The boy is wearing a blue one.

Baji 바지

Wide, baggy comfortable pants that are tied at the ankles and waist.



Baesi-daenggi 배시댕기

A decorated headband.

Jeogori 저고리

A loose-fitting top that covers the arms and upper body.

Jumeoni 주머니

A small, round drawstring purse believed to bring good fortune.

Kkotsin 꽃신

Embroidered silk shoes.

Chima 치마

A wide, wrap-around skirt that is tied high, just under the arms.

Norigae 노리개

A charm that hangs from the jacket. Thought to bring good luck, **norigae** are often handed down from mothers to their daughters.

Korean Homes Yesterday and Today

Home Sweet Home



Sarangbang 사랑방

In old times men and older boys always had separate rooms from the women and girls. The **sarangbang** or men's room, near the entrance gate, was a home's receiving room. Here wealthy Korean men would have a low desk, an inkstone and brushes for calligraphy, rolled paper scrolls, and books.

Ondol 온돌

Koreans heated their homes through the floor with a system called **ondol**. The heat of the kitchen fire was sent through the house with a network of stone ducts and flues. During warm weather, the flues were closed and the warm air was sent out chimneys instead.

Anbang 안방

The women's room was near the kitchen in the protected back part of the house. In old days, women cooked, heated water and kept the fire going. In their room women kept a dowry box filled with gifts for the family of future husbands, chests with clothes and blankets, and sewing supplies. All children slept in this room with their mothers, girls until they married and boys until they started school.

Traditionally, Korean homes were one story. Homes of the wealthy had tile roofs but most homes had thatched roofs. There was usually a wall surrounding each house so that

even if neighboring homes were nearby, a small interior courtyard gave a family some privacy.

Sinbal 신발

Sinbal (shoes) were always removed before entering a home. Since people sat on the floor, floors were kept spotlessly clean.

Bu-eok 부엌

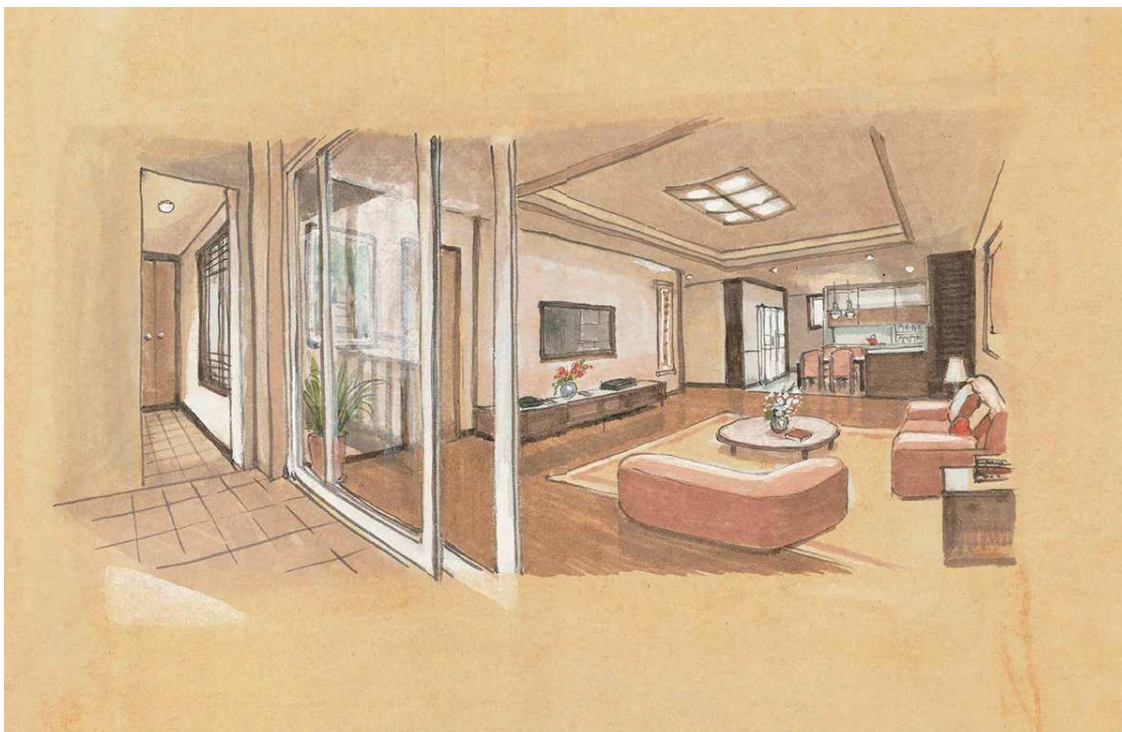
The only completely separate room of the house, the kitchen had cooking tools, a cooking hearth, and shelves filled with bowls, plates, and baskets.

Jangdokdae 장독대

This was the special place to store jars of **kimchi**, soy sauce, red pepper paste and pickled vegetables.

Maru 마루

The **maru** was a covered veranda that served as a dining room, living room, playroom, and study. This was a favorite spot to gather. It had a small amount of furniture, always low and moveable. People sat on cushions on the clean floor. During summertime, the roof provided shade and the open walls allowed a welcome breeze. During cooler weather, screen panels were put up to keep out cold and dampness.



Where do most Koreans live today? In apartments! Traditional Korean houses are still found in the countryside but with Korea's nearly 50 million people, most open flat land is needed for farming. Well-designed high-rise apartments are a good way to fit many homes

into a small space. Korean apartments are modern and efficient but it's interesting to notice how their layouts are similar to Korean homes of the past.

Hyeon-gwan-mun 현관문

The front door has taken the place of the entrance gate found in traditional Korean homes. It leads into the living area, or maru. Koreans always take off their shoes when indoors. Guests are usually offered slippers. It keeps floors cleaner, which is especially important because people continue to sit on the floor. Shoes are kept by the front door.

Beranda 베란다

Apartments often have front and back verandas or balconies which allow in fresh cooling breezes. The front balcony is often set up nicely with chairs and tables for enjoying the breezes while the back veranda, located near the kitchen, is used for more practical matters like washing clothes and storage.

Try it!

Take off your shoes every time you come inside for a week. Was this hard to do? Did your house stay cleaner?

Anbang 안방

Today, married couples sleep together in the **anbang**, the bedroom. Older Koreans continue to sleep on mats, which are folded away in the day to give room for other activities, but younger Koreans most often choose to sleep in Western-style beds.

Maru 마루

The living room is located in the center of the apartment. Koreans sit on the floor when extra people are visiting but almost all Korean living rooms have couches. Most Koreans eat their meals on chairs at a dining table but almost all families also have a very large, low table, which serves as a dining table when guests are visiting.

Bang 방

Extra bedrooms are used by children or by guests. Korean technology is cutting edge, and today most Koreans have computers, which are usually placed in a **bang**.

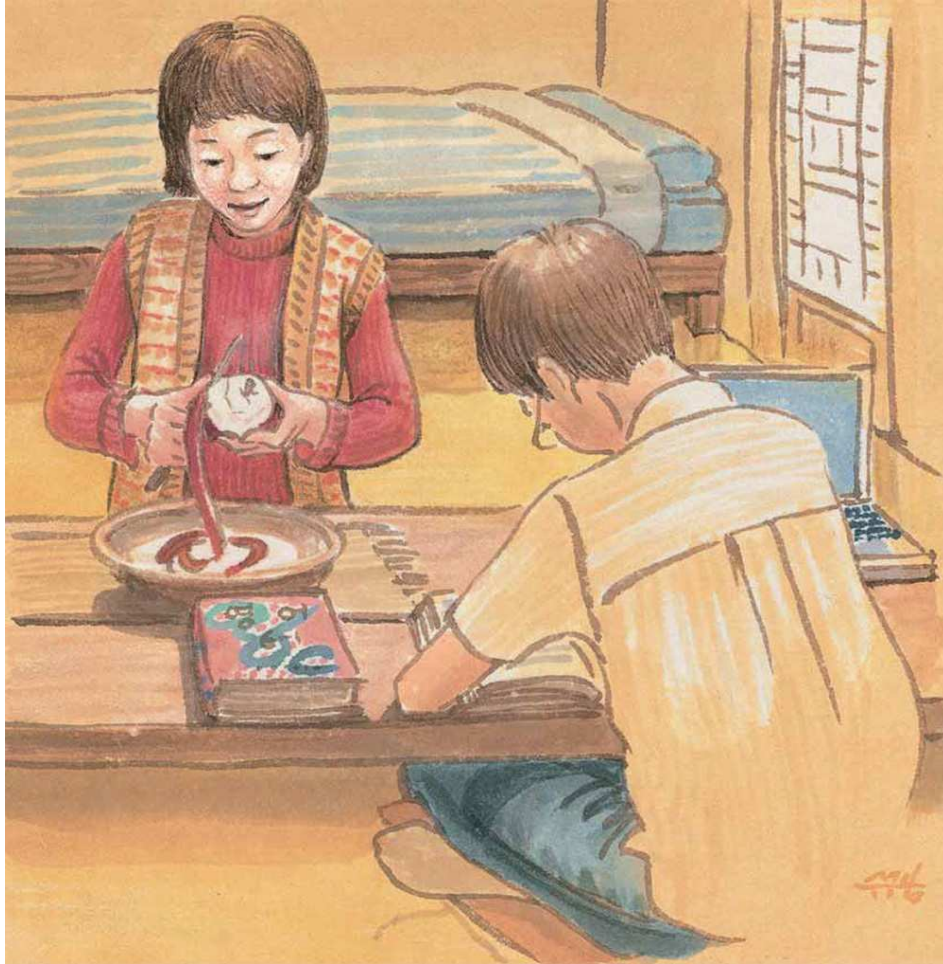
Bu-eok 부엌

Most cooking is done on a stovetop, so many kitchens do not have an oven. If they do it is used very little. Many families have dishwashers but some older Koreans prefer to wash dishes by hand.

Ondol 온돌

Korean apartments are heated with an **ondol** heating system, which is basically hot water that runs through pipes in the floor. This heating system makes it really cozy to sit on the floor.

Education Rules!



Education is very important to Koreans today. Korean children are expected to study hard. Mothers often help their children with studies. In Korea, people believe that a university education is the key to success...and to get into a university, kids must first pass an important test called the entrance exam. At the end of the school day, many children go to “cram school” to prepare for it. It is hard to be accepted into Korean universities, so the pressure is on for Korean kids, even very young ones, to get ready for entrance exams!

Showing Respect

Koreans believe it is very important to show each other respect whenever possible. Here are just a few of the ways they show respect to one another:

Parents try to **treat their children with kindness and respect**.
Parents feel this also shows respect to their ancestors.

Korean children feel it is their duty to **obey their parents**. Children work hard in school to show their parents respect.

Children **never call an adult by their first name**. Rather, they call them “elder man” (**ajeossi**, 아저씨) or “elder woman” (**ajumeoni**, 아주머니) as a sign of respect.

Children are expected to **clean their classrooms** each day to show they value their education.

Respect for elders is especially important. Koreans offer elders their seat on a bus, never interrupt when an elder is speaking, and bow (**jeol**, 절) to elders during special occasions like New Year’s Day.

A Korean Folktale

Two Foolish Green Frogs

Have you ever wondered why frogs croak on muddy riverbanks? This story is the Korean explanation. The Korean word for frog is gae-guri, and that’s also the sound it makes: “gae-gul, gae-gul.” Korean children who don’t obey their parents are called “cheong gae-guri” or “green frogs.” Read the story to understand why!



Long ago two young frogs lived with their mother by a lily pond. Sons are usually a blessing but this pair caused their mother a lot of worry. You see, they never did as they were told. They did exactly the opposite of what their mother wanted, just to be difficult.

One day when they were very young, Mother Frog called, “Sons, come for breakfast!”

Did the little green frogs listen to their mother? No, of course not! The brothers swam into the pond instead and dove off lily pads. Mother called, “Sons, you are too young to swim so far! Please come ashore and we’ll have breakfast.” But the frogs laughed and swam on and on.

Finally, Mother shouted, “Fine, skip breakfast! It leaves more for me.” Quick as a wink, the brothers swam to shore and gobbled their breakfast.

In the hot afternoon, Mother settled down for a nap and told the little frogs, “Time to be quiet.” But did the young frogs listen to their mother? No, of course not! The frogs naughtily yelled out some practice croaks—backward: “Gul-gae! GUL-GAE!”

Mother sighed. She explained, “You have it backward. ‘Gae-gul! Gae-gul!’ is the way we croak.” The young frogs giggled and kept on croaking backward: “Gul-gae! Gul-gae!”

Another day Mother said, “My sons, there are hungry foxes in the hills, so please play in the valley today.”

But did the young frogs listen to their mother? No, of course not! They hopped straight to the hills and chased grasshoppers. The frogs were so busy playing that they didn’t notice a pair of foxes slinking toward them.

“Look out!” yelled Mother, coming up the hill to find her sons. “Foxes are after you!”



The brothers hopped into the creek, just barely escaping the foxes' hungry teeth. Back at their lily pond, the brothers laughed, "Aren't we tricky to outsmart foxes?"

Mother scolded, "You could have been those foxes' supper!" which just made the little frogs laugh even harder.

Somehow Mother remained hopeful. She thought, "Perhaps my sons will grow wise with age."

This was not to be. Through winter, spring, summer and fall, year after year, the frog brothers did exactly as they pleased, never listening to their poor mother.

One day Mother said, "It's been raining long and hard. The river is too dangerous. Please go up into the hills to catch supper." But did the brothers listen to their mother? No, of course not! They hopped straight into the raging river to hunt for minnows. As her sons swam off, Mother shouted, "Be careful! You'll be pulled downstream."

The brothers chuckled as they swam toward the middle of the rushing river. The frogs were strong swimmers, but the current that day was too powerful. In an instant, the brothers were swirling toward a waterfall. "Help! Help!" they cried.

Mother croaked helplessly as her sons were pulled downstream. She could not bear to watch as her dear sons shot over the waterfall. She sprang along the riverbank to search for them.



Finding them finally, Mother dragged her injured sons from the water and frantically tended their many cuts and scrapes. Luck was with the foolish frogs. After weeks of their mother's tender care, both brothers recovered. But sadly, Mother did not.

Worn down with work and worry, Mother could barely lift her head. When it was clear she would not live long, Mother called her sons to her lily pad. "Sons, all your lives you have disobeyed me. I ask you to obey me just this once. When I die, do NOT bury me in my favorite grassy meadow above our lily pond. Please bury me in the muddy ground beside the river."

Now, Mother frog honestly wanted to be buried in the meadow above her beloved lily pond. But she thought the only way her wish would be fulfilled was if she asked for the opposite.

The sons were heartbroken when their mother died. With deep regret they said, "Why did we always disobey Mother?"

After a long silence, one brother said, "Perhaps we can make it up to her. Let's obey Mother's last request." With that, the brothers respectfully buried their mother in the muddy ground by the river.

That night, fierce rains began. The frog brothers sat mournfully by their mother's grave, croaking to the river, "Gae-gul! Gae-gul! Please don't wash

Mother away!”

The rain continued and the river swelled. All night long the worried brothers never left their mother’s grave. Other frogs joined their chorus:

“Gae-gul! Gae-gul! Please don’t wash Mother away!”

And to this day, during rainstorms, green frogs still gather on riverbanks calling, “Gae-gul! Gae-gul! Please don’t wash Mother away!”



Acknowledgments

As a non-Korean, it would have been impossible for me to write this book without the help and insights of many. Thank you Chris Winston, Denise Park, Young Seo Lee, Chong Byun, Chris LaCava, Jeong Spztzla, Erin Dealey, Steve Hall, Malcolm Dick, Dr. Euyoungso Park, Michelle Worley, Jeong Shin, Dr. Soohye Kim, Kyongsook Kim, Soomgyul Saebul, and all the families of Sacramento's Friends of Korea School! A giant thank you Jung Lee for patiently answering my endless questions. Many kudos to my fine editor, Sandra Korinchak; you made this book shine. Thanks to Tan Cheng Har and the Tuttle graphics and layout staff for all your hard work. Many thanks to Soonsoonam Barg. Your lovely illustrations bring the Korean culture to life. And finally, thanks to Sarah and Jacob for helping me with this book and to my entire family for your continual support. I hope you enjoyed this project as much as I did!

Resources

Helpful Internet Sites

<http://www.korea.net> Offers Korean news, maps, travel tips, historical and cultural information.

<http://www.visitkorea.or.kr/intro.html> Great site for those planning a trip to Korea.

<http://www.askasia.org> Reliable information about Asia designed for students and teachers.

<http://goldsea.com> A list of notable Asian Americans.

<http://www.inkas.or.kr/eng/index.asp> Helpful website for Korean adoptees and their families.

<http://www.kaanet.com> Helpful website for Korean adoptees and their families.

http://www.koreanfeast.com/korean_markets_in_the_us.htm A list of U.S. Korean markets.

http://www.kaanet.com/asian_links/ Links to many websites, including sources for purchasing Korean items.

<http://www.asiaforkids.com> An online catalogue offering language and culture books, videos, CD-ROMS, crafts, games, dolls and music.

Recommended Reading

Yunmi and Halmoni's Trip by Sook Nyul Choi, illustrated by Karen Dugan (Houghton Mifflin, 1997). Ages 4 & up.

Bee-Bim Bop by Linda Sue Park, illustrated by Bo Baek Lee (Clarion, 2005). Ages 2–6.

The Firekeeper's Son by Linda Sue Park, illustrated by Julia Downing (Clarion, 2004). Ages 4–8.

My Name Is Yoon by Helen Recorvits and Gabi Swiatkowska (Farrar, Straus & Giroux, 2003). Ages 4–8.

Peacebound Trains by Haemi Balgassi, illustrated by Chris Soentpiet (Clarion, 1996). Ages 7 & up.

The Korean Cinderella by Shirley Climo, illustrated by Ruth Heller (Harper Collins, 1993). Ages 5–9.

Korean Children's Favorite Stories by Kim So-Un, illustrated by Jeong Kyoung-Sim (Tuttle Publishing, 2004). Ages 5–12.

Sixteen Years in Sixteen Seconds by Paula Yoo, illustrated by Dom Lee (Lee & Low, 2005). Ages 5–10.

A Year of Impossible Goodbyes by Sook Nyul Choi (Yearling, 1993). Ages 10 & up.

Growing Up in a Korean Kitchen: A Cookbook, by Hi Soo Shin Hepinstall (Ten Speed Press, 2001). Ages 12 & up.

Asian Kites by Wayne Hosking (Tuttle Publishing, 2004). Ages 10 & up.

Finding My Voice by Marie Lee (Harperteen, 2001). Ages 12 & up.

A Step from Heaven by An Na (Front Street, 2001). Ages 10 & up.

The Legend of Hong Kil Dong: The Robin Hood of Korea by Annie Sibley O'Brien (Charlesbridge Publishing, 2008). Ages 8–12.

The Kite Fighters by Linda Sue Park (Yearling, 2002). Ages 9–12.

A Single Shard by Linda Sue Park (Clarion, 2001). Ages 10 & up.

When My Name Was Keoko, by Linda Sue Park (Yearling, 2005). Ages 10 & up.

For more good books about Koreans, Korean-Americans or Asian topics, visit:

http://www.cynthialeitichsmith.com/lit_resources/diversity/asian_am/korean.html

<http://www.papertigers.org>

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Ann Martin Bowler worked as an educator for many years and now writes full time. She has visited Korea with her family many times and travels

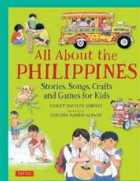
widely in Asia. Her two youngest children, Sarah and Jacob, were adopted from Korea. Jake helped with the development of this book's crafts and Sarah helped with the recipes. Bowler's other books include *Adventures of the Treasure Fleet* (also available from Tuttle Publishing). She lives in the California foothills. Visit her website at www.AnnMartinBowler.com.



Soosoonam Barg was born in Seoul, Korea, and was drawn to painting from an early age. She teaches art and tapestry weaving at schools and her studio in New Jersey, as well as at schools in Korea. She was presented with The Scholastic

Arts & Writing award in recognition for being an outstanding educator. She has been profiled by the *New York Times* for her artwork. She is building her dream house in the countryside of Korea, near her mother's birthplace village, and travels there often. Visit her website at www.soyooart.com.

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